

28 THE UNITED KINGDOM – FACTS, CULTURE AND PEOPLE

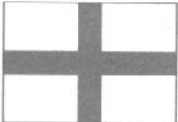


*I wandered lonely as a cloud
That floats on high o'er vales and hills,
When all at once I saw a crowd,
A host, of golden daffodils;
Beside the lake, beneath the trees,
Fluttering and dancing in the breeze.*

(from: "I Wandered Lonely as a Cloud" by William Wordsworth,
the Lake District poet of the early 19th century)

Study the following box which contains facts about the UK. Underline the facts which you were not aware of.

THE UNITED KINGDOM OF GREAT BRITAIN AND NORTHERN IRELAND

country/ capital/ flag	England Capital: London 	Scotland Capital: Edinburgh 	Wales Capital: Cardiff 	Northern Ireland (Ulster) Capital: Belfast 
languages	English	English Gaelic	English Welsh (Celtic language)	English Irish
other famous cities	Brighton Cambridge Oxford Liverpool Manchester	Glasgow Edinburgh Dundee	Swansea	Londonderry Armagh [arma:]
places of inte- rest	Lake District English countryside coast	Highlands: Loch Lomond and Loch Ness – Highland Games and Festivals	mountains Snowdon (1100 m above sea level)	Giant's Causeway
economy	<i>industry:</i> – computing – banking – insurance – commerce – finance – advertising <i>agriculture</i>	<i>industry:</i> – engineering – printing – electronic industries – shipbuilding – heavy steel manufacture	<i>industry:</i> – coal mining	<i>agriculture:</i> – livestock, cattle
stereo- types	– reserved – conservative – polite – self-disciplined – reliable – specific sense of humour	– independent – proud of their culture and heritage	– love of music and poetry	– patriotic – music and dance lovers

□ DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

Before reading the text, discuss the following questions in class.

1. Which English-speaking countries have you been to?
2. Which English-speaking countries would you like to go to in the future?
3. Which countries is Great Britain comprised of?
4. Which countries form the United Kingdom?
5. What is the official language of Great Britain?
6. What do you know about Northern Ireland and the Republic of Ireland?
7. What do you know about Great Britain's political system?
8. What currency is used in England?
9. Have you ever met any British people? Where were they from? What were they like?
10. Read the verse by W. Wordsworth at the top of the previous page. Which part of Britain do you think he is writing about? How does the poet see the country that he is writing about?

□ TEXT

Read the texts below in silence. Check the meaning of the words in bold and answer the questions below.

THE UNITED KINGDOM (UK) OF GREAT BRITAIN AND NORTHERN IRELAND

The United Kingdom (UK) of Great Britain and Northern Ireland is situated on the British Isles which lie off the northwest coast of Europe. Great Britain **comprises** England, Scotland and Wales. Together with Northern Ireland it forms **the United Kingdom**. It **includes** four nations: the English, Scottish, **Welsh** and Irish people. They all differ in their way of life, **customs, values** and traditions. The largest cities of the UK are *London, Birmingham, Glasgow, Liverpool, Manchester, Sheffield, Bristol, Leeds* and *Edinburgh*. The UK is an **industrialised** country – major industries include iron and **steel engineering, textiles**, plastics, cotton, chemicals, electronics, wool, shipbuilding and **food processing**. The islands are rich in mineral **resources** and **coal mining** was once a major industry. The **chief** agricultural products are **wheat, barley, oats**, potatoes, **sugar beet**, milk and meat.

1. Which nations make up the UK?
2. Which are currently the major industries in the UK according to the text?

ENGLAND

England **occupies** the largest, southern part of Great Britain. The southwest and west are largely **plains**, hills and **moors**. England has about 60 million inhabitants over 130 000 square kilometres making it one of the most **densely** populated countries in

the world. The country is divided into 36 counties. *Lancashire, Yorkshire, Warwickshire, Hampshire, Kent, Cheshire, Durham, Essex* and *Sussex* are the largest and the most populated. The capital of England and of Great Britain is *London*.

England is highly industrialised. The development of industry started during the period of the Industrial Revolution in the late 18th and early 19th centuries. Recently, there have been many changes in the structure of the country's economy. New "modern" industries and **enterprises** have developed. The biggest **growth** has been in computing, banking, **insurance**, commerce, finance and **advertising**.

England has a very rich architecture. Many of the greatest cathedrals and churches were built between 1100 and 1500. Many can still be seen today in towns that have **retained** much of their original character.

The English countryside is **remarkable** for its green fields and trees. Small villages and old market towns look beautiful with their well-kept gardens and houses. The country has a long **coastline** with many famous seaside resorts, such as *Brighton, Bournemouth* and *Torquay* on the south coast. The most beautiful natural **scenery** can be seen in the north-west of England in the *Lake District*, an area which **inspired** many of the English romantic poets.

3. What kind of countryside is typical for England?
4. What is the Lake District famous for?

SCOTLAND

Scotland is a wonderful country – full of traditions and romance. It retains its own character and way of life. It has more than 5 million inhabitants. Scotland has been a part of Great Britain since 1707, but the Scottish people **remain** very independent and **proud of** their culture and **heritage**. They speak various dialects of English and 60 000 also speak Gaelic, an **ancient** Scottish language. Scotland is a country of hills, lakes (called lochs), fast **flowing** rivers and deep **valleys**. The most beautiful part of Scotland is the region known as the *Highlands*. The most famous lakes are *Loch Lomond* and *Loch Ness* where a **mythical** monster, Nessie, lives **according to** legends.

There are four big cities in Scotland – *Glasgow, Edinburgh, Dundee* and *Aberdeen*. *Edinburgh*, the ancient capital of Scotland, is one of the most beautiful cities in the world. It has become an international centre of music and drama and is famous for its **annual** festival – the *Edinburgh International Festival of Music and Drama*. Edinburgh is also famous for its engineering, **printing** and electronic industries. *Glasgow*, situated on the river *Clyde*, was once known all over the world for its shipbuilding and heavy steel manufacturing, although these industries have almost **vanished** now. Scotland has its own legal and educational systems.

5. Which Scottish towns and places are worth seeing?
6. What are Scottish people like according to the text?

WALES

Wales is a largely **mountainous** country. It has an eastern land **border** with England. The oldest son of the English **monarch** and the **successor** to the English **throne** is given the title "Prince of Wales". Wales is famous for its long rivers, wide lakes and high hills in the north of the country. The highest mountain in the north, *Snowdon*, is 1 100 metres above sea level and can be found in the region called Snowdonia. The population of Wales is about 3 million people in an area of just under 21 000 square kilometres. The majority of the people live in the coal-mining and industrial region of the south around *Cardiff*, the capital of Wales and *Swansea*.

7. Who is the "Prince of Wales"?
8. What is Wales famous for according to the text above?

NORTHERN IRELAND

Northern Ireland (also known as *Ulster*) is a part of the United Kingdom. *Belfast*, the capital, is the educational, commercial, entertainment and service centre of Northern Ireland. It is also an important **port**. As most of the country is **rural**, agricultural products and **livestock account for** much of Northern Ireland's exports. There are many small farms producing pigs, **cattle**, milk and eggs. The politics of Northern Ireland and people's lives have been dominated by religious and economic problems. The whole of Ireland was connected to Britain from 1800, although parts had been occupied by Britain since 1167. *The Republic of Ireland* (also known as *Eire*) became independent in 1922, while Northern Ireland remained a part of the UK. *Eire* is almost totally Roman Catholic **whereas** just over half of the population of Northern Ireland is Protestant and about 40 per cent are Catholic. The Catholic community want Northern Ireland to join *Eire*, whereas the Protestant community want to remain part of the UK. Old **hatred** between Protestants and Catholics have been kept alive, with years of **civil unrest** and terrorist attacks by both sides. Many lives have been lost and many bombings and terrorist attacks were aimed at **targets** in Britain. While problems remain in Northern Ireland, the level of violence there has greatly decreased, especially since the Irish Republican Army (the IRA) agreed to fully **disarm** in 2005. In a survey **conducted** by Queens University Belfast and the University of Ulster, 73% of people in Northern Ireland said they wished to remain part of the UK and 16% said they wished Northern Ireland to leave the UK and **unify** with the Republic of Ireland.

9. Which countries are known as Ulster and Eire?
10. Based on your reading, explain the reason for the clashes between Protestants and Catholics in Northern Ireland.

□ VOCABULARY LIST

according to – podľa
advertising (AmE: advertizing) – reklama
ancient – prastarý
annual – každoročný
barley – jačmeň
border – hranica
cattle – dobytok
chief – hlavný
civil unrest – občiansky nepokoj
coal mining – ťažba uhlia
coastline – pobrežie
to comprise [kəmpraɪz] – obsahovať, skladať sa
to conduct – viesť
custom [kʌstəm] – zvyk
densely – husto
to disarm – odzbrojiť
enterprise [entəpraɪz] – podnik
to flow – tečiť (rieka)
food processing – spracovanie potravín
growth – rast
hatred [heɪtrɪd] – nenávisť
heritage [herɪtɪdʒ] – dedičstvo
to include – zahrňovať
industrialised [ɪndʌstriəlaɪzd] (AmE: industrialize) – industrializovaný
to inspire [ɪnspəɪə] – inšpirovať
insurance [ɪnʃʊərəns] – poisťovníctvo
livestock – hospodárske zvieratá
monarch – panovník

moor [mʊə, also mɔ:] – močiar
mountainous – hornatý
mythical [mɪθɪkl] – legendárny
oat [aʊt] – ovos
to occupy [ɒkjupaɪ] – zaberat'
plain – rovina
port – prístav
to print – tlačiť
to remain – zostať, pretrvávajúť
remarkable – pozoruhodný
resource – zdroj
to retain – zachovať
rural [ruərəl] – vidiecky
scenery [siːnəri] – scenéria
steel engineering – oceliarsky priemysel
successor – nasledovník
sugar beet [bi:t] – cukrová trstina
target – cieľ
textile [tekstaɪl] – textil
throne – trón
unify [juːnɪfaɪ] – zjednotiť
valley – údolie
value – hodnota
to vanish – zmiznúť
Welsh – obyvatelia Walesu, waleský
wheat [wi:t] – pšenica
whereas – kým, zatiaľ čo

to account for – činiť, podieľať sa
to be proud of – byť pyšný na

□ VOCABULARY PRACTICE

Task 1 Map reading

a) Using the map below show where the following places are:

- the United Kingdom/Great Britain
- England/Scotland/Wales/Northern Ireland
- London/Glasgow/Cardiff/Belfast

b) Point to the places you have marked on the map and make sentences with the verbs in the box:

Example: Great Britain (show on the map) comprises England, Scotland and Wales (show on the map).

to occupy
to be situated
to cover
to comprise
to be divided
to border
to lie (in the north, south, east, west)
to spread
to be located
to inhabit



Your sentences: ✎
